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Forest Society And Colonialism,

- 1) Major and Minor forest Products.
- 2) Maintain ecological balance.
- 3) Provide shelter to wild animals i.e. Wildlife.
- 4) Provide employment to the Tribals.
- 5) Soil conservation.
- 6) Maintenance of the seasons and climate.
Forests are shrinking.

- The cutting down of the Forests or their disappearance is called Deforestation.

- As per the India State of Forest Report (ISFR)

2023-24 → India has 7,15,343 sq. km. Forest Area.

⇒ Causes of Deforestation:

1) Agricultural Expansion → To bring more land in

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Agriculture.

- In 1600 $\rightarrow \frac{1}{6th}$ of Total landmass of India was under Agriculture.

$\rightarrow$ Between 1880 - 1920 $\rightarrow$ 7 million Hectare of land is under agriculture.

$\rightarrow$ At present = 153.90 ^{million} Hectares of land Under agriculture. (1 Hectare = 20 kanal).

2) Introduction of New Crop.

- Jute, Indigo, Sugar, Tea, Coffee, Cotton, Tobacco.

3) Sleepers for the Railway Track.

- Forest were cut for making sleepers of the Railway Tracks.



- ★ ⇒ One Mile of Railway needed 1760 - 2000 sleepers.
- 4) Wood or Timber for ship building:-
- Special tree for ship building was Oak Tree.
- 5) Promotion of Tea Plantation:-
- 6) Fuel for the steam Engine. Fire wood as fuel for steam engines.
- 7) Construction of the dams and reservoirs.
- 8) Urbanisation: Emergence of new Towns and cities.
- 9) Mining: i.e. extraction of minerals from the forest land.
- 10) Industrialisation: Emergence of new Industries from the forest land.
- 11) Laying of the ~~roads~~ Roads Through the Forest.

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⇒ Rise of Commercial Forestry:-

- 1) The major and minor forest products have now been sold in the market to earn money.
- 2) British govt. managed the Indian Forest on commercial lines i.e. as commercial or Profit Purpose.
- 3) The British Govt. Invited German Scientist Dietrich Brandis.
- 4) He gave his suggestions for the Commercial Forestry.
- 5) He was made as the first Inspector General of the forest. (IG) in India.
- 6) In 1864:- He introduced Indian Forest Service



(IFS). and Indian Forest act in 1865.

7) Dietrich Brandis also set up Indian Forest Research Institute in Dehradun (UP) and at present in Uttarakhand. (IFRI).

⇒ Features/Provisions of the Forest Act of 1865:-
(or its ~~important~~ impact on Tribals).

- 1) Only the dead or Diseased trees to be extracted from the forest.
- 2) New trees be planted in the places of all trees.
- 3) Trees are to be planted in the straight lines, with a particular type of trees in a particular region.
- 4) Forest officials to Inspect forest regularly.



- 5) No grazing of the cattle allowed in the forest.
- 6) This Act did not permit any Tribal to extract any ~~deprived of their right~~ forest product from the forest.
- 7) The tribals were dislocated from the forest and deprived of their right.
- 8) They could not raise cattle as their means of livelihood.

⇒ In 1878:- Forest Amendment act of 1878.
Divided Forest into 3 categories.

- ① Reserved Forests No forest activity were allowed.
- ② Protected Forest → Very minor and permitted forest Activity allowed.
- ③ Village Forest.



⇒ Who could Hunt Hunt Animals. In The Forests?

- 1) The Wolves, Tigers and Leopards were considered as threat to the cultivators and their crop.
- 2) So poaching of such animals was permitted.
- 3) Those ~~was~~ who hunted such animals were awarded with Silver caps, Trophies or shields.
- 4) An Animal event to kill wild ~~a~~ animals was held and called as Big Game / Big Hunt.
- 5) Between 1875 - 1925 → 80,000 Tigers, 1,50,00 Leopards and ~~200~~ 2,00,000 Wolves were hunted.
- 6) George Jule → Alone hunted 400 Tigers, and Maharaja of Sarguja (Chatisgarh) alone killed 1157 Tigers and 2000 Leopards by 1957.



→ Forest Rebellion:

- The Rebellion in the forests by the Tribals against the forest Act of 1865 were called Forest Rebellion.
- Main cause of the Forest Rebellion was the implementation of Forest Act of 1865 by the British Govt.
- Bastar Rebellion:

- 1) Bastar is a district in Chattisgarh state.
- Chatt. Chattisgarh has been created from Andhra Pradesh state in 2000.
- 2) The District Headquarter of Bastar is Jagdalpur.
- 3) ~~Population~~ Population of Bastar is slightly



over one Lakh.

- 4) Gonds, Halbar, Marias, Murias, Bhatrias, Dhure are some tribal communities of Bastar.
- speak different dialects and have different cultures.
- 5) They worship Mother earth and some Forest and Rivers spirits.
- 6) They had to pay ~~a~~ some amount for extracting any forest product from the forests of other Villages:- That amount was called Dersori.
- 7) They ~~had to~~ appointed some forest Guards to ~~protect~~ protect the forest who were paid by the Village.



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- 8) In 1905:- British Govt. dispossessed the Tribals of the forest land and owned the Forests as Govt. land.
- 9) This Forest act and the Forest Reservation Policy became the main Cause of the Bastar Rebellion.
- 10) British took ~~the~~ forced labour from the Tribals which was called Beggar. i.e; Forced work without payment.
- 11) Bastar Rebellion was initiated in 1910 from the Kanger forest of Andhra Pradesh in the Nathaniya Village.
- 12) This Rebellion was led by a Tribal chief namely Gunda Dhur.



- 13) In 1910 → The messages regarding the rebellion were sent to all the villages through the symbols of Chillies, Arrows etc.
- 14) The ~~tribal~~ ^{rebel} ~~adivasis~~ looted the godowns, attacked the ~~hous~~ houses of the officials and even Police Stations and the Govt. buildings were burnt.
- 15) In return, British Govt. dropped the ~~rebellion~~ ^{rebelle} and tried to curb the rebellion.
- 16) The British Govt. finally reduced the Reservation policy to One-Third which was earlier One-Half. and allowed tribal to graze their cattle and collect some forest products from the forest and this rebellion came to an end.



- Munda Rebellion: Led by Birsa Munda.
- Ramper Rebellion: Led by Alluri Sitarama
- Bastar Rebellion: Led by Gunda Dhur.

⇒ Forest Transformation in Java:

- 1) Java is a densest Island in Indonesia.
- 2) Indonesia was a Dutch colony, i.e; Netherlands
↳ Remained in the Dutch control for about 300 yrs.
- 3) Indonesia finally got Independence Dutch Rule on 17th Aug - 1949 → It was called previously as Dutch East Indies.
- 4) Agriculture is the main occupation in Indonesia and forest products as the main source of foreign exchange.
- 5) The Indonesian or Java Tribal Communities



Include Javanese, Osing, Tengerese, Cirebonese, Madures, Betauri, etc.

⇒ Wood Cutters of Java:-

- 1) The Java's Skilled and specialised wood cutter community is called Kalang Community.
- 2) kalangs build the Palaces for the kings.
- 3) In 1775:- Mataram kingdom with 600 kalang families splitted into two kingdoms where 300 kalang families given to each kingdom.

⇒ Dutch Scientific Forestry:-

- 1) ~~Java~~ Dutch Forest laws or Act did not give Java villagers free access to the forests.
- 2) Java People were not allowed to graze their



cattle in the forests, cut trees.

- 3) However they ^{could} ~~could~~ extract some forest products under licence.
- 4) They were not allowed to walk across the forest roads in carts.
- 5) Dutch imposed rent on the forest lands.
- 6) Some Java Tribals were exempted from paying land rents. and in return they had to cut trees and extract wood and timber on the buffalo carts without wages. This system was called Blondongdienstein system.
- 7) This Blondongdienstein system was later made ^{as} ~~an~~ Low Wage bonded Labour system.



⇒ Saminist Movement:

- 1) In Java, there is a village Randublatung, where Surintika Samin lives.
- 2) Samin launched a movement or rebellion against the Dutch Forest law.
- 3) They (Samin and his supporters) called Saminists, refused to obey Dutch Forest Law.
- 4) This movement is called Samin's Forest Rebellion and took place in 1907.

⇒ Indian Tribal Groups:-

- Gonds, Mundas, Sherpas, Labadis, Koroaks, Bakermals, Gujars, Bajoras, Santhals, etc.